

Baby Contact Nap Survival Guide — Action Checklist

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CONFIRM BABY'S READINESS

- ❑ **Confirm Baby Is Age-Ready:** Wait until your baby is at least 8-10 weeks old (adjusted age if premature) before starting this transition process, since newborns under that age have immature sleep architecture that makes the method less effective.
- ❑ **Rule Out Hunger First:** Feed your baby thoroughly before each nap attempt and confirm that hunger is not the primary reason they wake up, because introducing the transfer while they're still hungry will only lead to frustration for everyone involved.
- ❑ **Choose a Low-Stress Start Window:** Ensure you have at least one full week of relatively calm days with minimal outside obligations before beginning this protocol, so unexpected visitors or travel don't disrupt the progress you're trying to build.
- ❑ **Watch for Early Tired Cues:** Look for decreased activity, slow blinking, heavy eyelids, hand sucking, or mild fussiness that comes and goes, because starting your sleep routine at the early cues prevents your baby from becoming overtired and fighting sleep.

WATCH FOR SLEEP CUES

- ❑ **Avoid Late Tired Cues:** Take immediate action when you notice intense crying, screaming, hyperactive behavior, or back arching, since these are signs your baby is overtired with elevated cortisol that makes falling asleep much harder to achieve.
 - ❑ **Start Your Routine at First Signs:** Begin your nap routine the moment you see early tired cues rather than waiting for more obvious signs, because catching the optimal sleep window reduces the overall battle and helps your baby fall asleep more easily.
 - ❑ **Wait 20 Minutes Before Moving:** After your baby falls asleep, wait a full 20 minutes before attempting any movement to ensure they have reached deep NREM stage 3 sleep, which is the stage where they are least likely to wake up from being moved.
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- ❑ **Move Deliberately When Transferring:** Walk extremely slowly and avoid any jerky movements as you carry your baby toward the crib, because the Moro reflex fires whenever your baby feels unsupported in mid-air and causes instant wake-ups.

PERFECT THE CRIB TRANSFER

- ❑ **Lower Baby Over 10 Seconds:** Spend a full 10 seconds lowering your baby the final 6 inches to the crib to prevent the Moro reflex from waking them, keeping the movement smooth and continuous rather than dropping them onto the mattress.
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- ❑ **Keep Hand on Chest After Placing Down:** Maintain gentle pressure on your baby's chest for several seconds after laying them down to help them stay calm, then lift your hand away very slowly while watching to see if they remain settled.
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- ❑ **Hold Still If Baby Stirs:** Stay completely motionless if your baby begins to stir after being placed down and place your hand gently on their chest without speaking, waiting for them to resettle before you consider picking them back up.
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- ❑ **Wait Before Assuming They've Woken:** Keep your hand on your baby's chest for a full 30 seconds before concluding they've fully woken up, because shallow sleep movements during the transition phase often resolve on their own without intervention.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.